Comparing like fractions

To compare like fractions, check the numerators of the given fractions.

Example 6.9

Compare the shaded and unshaded part in the following figure.



Solution

A strip is divided into 7 equal parts. It means that each part represents $\frac{1}{7}$.

The coloured part is $\frac{3}{7} = \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{7}$

The uncoloured part is $\frac{4}{7} = \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{7}$

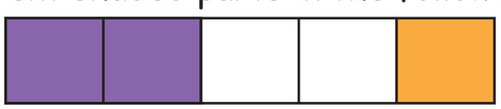
The coloured part is less than the uncoloured part.

This tells us that $\frac{3}{7}$ is less than $\frac{4}{7}$

This is written as $\frac{3}{7} < \frac{4}{7}$

Example 6.10

Compare the different shaded parts in the following figure.



Solution

This strip is divided into 5 equal parts. 2 out of 5 parts have one colour and 1 has another colour.

The fraction of blue coloured part = $\frac{2}{5}$

The fraction of yellow coloured part = $\frac{1}{5}$

Comparing the numerators 2 and 1, we find $2 > 1$

Therefore $\frac{2}{5} > \frac{1}{5}$.

In like fractions, the fraction with the greater numerator is the greater fraction.

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